The army and the state were therefore always interconnected in the minds of the majority. The opinion about the army taking over given the current climate was often split, though supporters for both the army and democracy were found in all focus groups.

The political leadership is not able to handle the current situation.[55]

> *We are not politically stable. People are not politically aware, not educated to elect the right lot. Would've opted for democracy for a country that was educated. The masses here are uneducated.*
>
> (Focus Group, Private University[56])

Those who support army rule say that they are '*better organized; [there is] no corruption; one rank to the next [is] based on ability – baap ki jaagird nahi' [it's not based on your father's inheritance]* (Focus Group, Private University[57]). Some support the army because their parents do or some because the army is visible in times of need, and the rest of the state is not: '*Whenever there is a natural disaster, earthquake or floods only the army goes in*' (Academic, Male, Quetta; Student, Female, Quetta[58]). Others point out that '*the reason the army is doing everything is because of the enormous budget that goes directly to the army. They are doing it because they can*' (Focus Group, Private University[59]). However, while the army's larger budget (in comparison to other government departments such as education and health) is considered a factor in its efficiency, there continued to be little faith in state institutions to perform, no matter how large their budget, because of corruption and lack of accountability. There are also those who point out that being anti-state or anti-army is not a choice: '*You can't go against the state narrative, or critique the army'; 'People who critique the army are labelled anti-patriotic. It is like "political suicide*'" (Focus Group, Private University[60]). Many also give reasons as to why the army is or should be running the show: some point to a weak democracy, where the political parties are unable to run the country. Hence the army is compelled to intervene politically. '*The army does not want to be in power but is being forced because the government is not standing. Look at the Sindh government. The army is running the whole show because the Sindh government is not doing it*' (Focus Group, Private University[61]) Others point to an uneducated and poor majority, that is incapable of practising their rights as voters:

> *In a country like Pakistan democracy does not work. There is so much poverty. You give people a little money and they will vote for you for the rest of their lives.' An example is given: 'They voted out of sympathy for [Asif*